

E007

Agile Methodology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Midway through a sprint, a senior vice president asks one of the team's seven developers to move a new report to the top of the product backlog. Who is accountable for ordering the product backlog?

- A. The Product Owner.
- B. The developers, by majority vote.
- C. The senior vice president, because of seniority.
- D. The Scrum Master.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

The sprint ended on a Friday before a holiday, and the team demoed the new feature to three customers. Now the team wants to discuss why handoffs to testing keep delaying work and agree on one improvement. Which event is for this?

- A. The Sprint Review.
- B. The Sprint Retrospective.
- C. The Daily Scrum.
- D. The Sprint Review, since customers attended the demo.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which Scrum event exists for stakeholders and the team to inspect the product increment and adjust the product backlog?

- A. The Daily Scrum.
- B. Sprint Planning.
- C. The Sprint Review.
- D. The Sprint Retrospective.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A team has 180 story points left in its release backlog. Its last three sprints delivered 28, 32, and 30 points. Sprints are two weeks long, and the team moved to a new office floor last month. At its average velocity, how many more sprints will the release take?

- A. About 5.6 sprints
- B. 6 sprints
- C. 5,400 sprints
- D. 12 sprints

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A release has 150 story points left and must ship in 5 sprints. What average velocity does the team need?

- A. None — agile teams never forecast delivery.
- B. 30 points per sprint
- C. 750 points per sprint
- D. 150 points per sprint

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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6.

A support team's Kanban board has five columns and a purple theme. It shows 24 items in progress, and the team finishes about 8 items per day. What is the average cycle time for an item?

- A. 5 days, one per column
- B. 192 days
- C. 3 days
- D. About 0.33 days

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team has 24 items in progress and finishes 8 items per day. It wants average cycle time to drop to 2 days without changing throughput. What WIP limit should it set?

- A.** 4 items
- B.** 32 items, so more work starts sooner
- C.** 16 items
- D.** 24 items

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 5-point story meets every acceptance criterion, and the Product Owner loved the demo. The team's Definition of Done requires peer review and passing automated tests, but the code has not been peer-reviewed yet. What is the story's status?

- A.** Not done; it fails the Definition of Done.
- B.** Done, because all acceptance criteria are met.
- C.** Half done, so the team counts 2.5 points.
- D.** Done, because the Product Owner liked the demo.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A value stream map shows a change request takes 20 days from request to release. Only 2 of those days are hands-on work; the rest is waiting in approval queues. The team uses a popular ticketing tool and its developers are the fastest in the company. What is the flow efficiency, and where is the biggest gain?

- A.** 10%; switch to a faster ticketing tool.
- B.** 90%; the process is already efficient.
- C.** 10%; have developers code faster.
- D.** 10%; cut the waiting time in approval queues.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A team has the highest velocity in the department. In retrospectives, a junior developer never raises concerns. Two months ago, the tech lead criticized a teammate in front of everyone for reporting a mistake. What should the Scrum Master do?

- A. Run one anonymous survey and make no other change.
- B. Leave it alone, since velocity is high.
- C. Require the junior developer to speak at every retrospective.
- D. Coach the tech lead to treat mistakes as learning and model blameless discussion.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

Three months into a project, a customer's market shifts and it asks for a different feature to come first. The original plan is 60 pages and was signed by the steering committee. What is the most agile response?

- A. Follow the plan because the steering committee signed it.
- B. Finish the original plan first, then consider the request.
- C. Stop all planning, since agile teams do not plan.
- D. Work with the Product Owner to reorder the backlog around the new priority.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement correctly reflects the Agile Manifesto?

- A. Working software is valued more than comprehensive documentation, though documentation still has value.
- B. Processes and tools are valued more than individuals and interactions.
- C. Comprehensive documentation is valued more than working software.
- D. Documentation has no value on agile teams.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

Midway through a sprint, ~~a senior vice president asks one of the team's seven developers~~ to move a new report to the top of the product backlog. Who is accountable for ordering the product backlog?

Target word: backlog ordering accountability **Decides:** Scrum assigns backlog ordering to one role.

A	Correct	The Product Owner is accountable for ordering the product backlog.
B	Adjacent category	Developers own how to build the work, not the backlog order.
C	Camouflage	Stakeholders influence priorities through the Product Owner, not directly.
D	Confusion set	The Scrum Master coaches and removes impediments; it does not set priorities.

2. Answer B Concept 2

The sprint ~~ended on a Friday before a holiday, and the team demoed the new feature to three customers~~. Now the team wants to discuss why handoffs to testing keep delaying work and agree on one improvement. Which event is for this?

Target word: event for process improvement **Decides:** The topic is how the team works.

A	Confusion set	The Review inspects the product increment, not the team's process.
B	Correct	The Retrospective inspects the team's process and plans improvements.
C	Adjacent category	The Daily Scrum plans the next day's work toward the sprint goal.
D	Camouflage	The demo already happened; customer attendance does not decide this event.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

Which Scrum event exists for stakeholders and the team to inspect the product increment and adjust the product backlog?

Target word: event for the product — reverse of the retrospective item **Decides:** The focus is the product increment with stakeholders.

A	Confusion set	A short developer event, not a stakeholder inspection.
B	Adjacent category	Planning selects work for the next sprint; it does not inspect the finished increment.
C	Correct	The Review inspects the increment and adapts the backlog.
D	Inverted operation	The Retrospective looks at the process, not the product.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A team has 180 story points left in its release backlog. Its last three sprints delivered 28, 32, and 30 points. ~~Sprints are two weeks long, and the team moved to a new office floor last month~~. At its average velocity, how many more sprints will the release take?

Target word: sprints remaining **Decides:** Average velocity = $(28 + 32 + 30) / 3 = 30$.

A	Wrong stem number	Uses the best sprint (32) instead of the average.
B	Correct	$180 / 30 = 6$.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies points by velocity instead of dividing.
D	Adjacent category	Converts to weeks (6×2) and answers in the wrong unit.

5. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

A release has 150 story points left and must ship in 5 sprints. What average velocity does the team need?

Target word: solve for velocity **Decides:** Velocity = points / sprints.

A	Absolute language	Agile teams forecast from velocity all the time.
B	Correct	$150 / 5 = 30$.
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.
D	Wrong stem number	The total remaining points, not a per-sprint rate.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A support team's Kanban board ~~has five columns and a purple theme. It shows 24 items in progress, and the team finishes about 8 items per day. What is the average cycle time for an item?~~

Target word: cycle time **Decides:** Little's Law: WIP / throughput.

A	Camouflage	The column count does not set cycle time.
B	Inverted operation	Multiplies WIP by throughput.
C	Correct	$24 / 8 = 3$ days.
D	Confusion set	Divides throughput by WIP.

7. Answer C Concept 4 · transfer

A team has 24 items in progress and finishes 8 items per day. It wants average cycle time to drop to 2 days without changing throughput. What WIP limit should it set?

Target word: solve for WIP **Decides:** WIP = cycle time × throughput.

A	Confusion set	Divides throughput by cycle time.
B	Inverted operation	Raising WIP lengthens cycle time.
C	Correct	$2 \times 8 = 16$.
D	Wrong stem number	The current WIP, which produces the 3-day cycle time.

8. Answer A Concept 5

~~A 5-point story meets every acceptance criterion, and the Product Owner loved the demo. The team's Definition of Done requires peer review and passing automated tests, but the code has not been peer-reviewed yet. What is the story's status?~~

Target word: done or not **Decides:** The Definition of Done is not met.

A	Correct	Done requires both acceptance criteria and the team's Definition of Done.
B	Confusion set	Acceptance criteria alone do not make an item done.
C	Dropped element	Scrum does not give partial credit; the item stays in progress.
D	Camouflage	Approval of the demo does not replace quality steps.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A value stream map shows a change request takes 20 days from request to release. Only 2 of those days are hands-on work; the rest is waiting in approval queues. ~~The team uses a popular ticketing tool and its developers are the fastest in the company.~~ What is the flow efficiency, and where is the biggest gain?

Target word: flow efficiency and focus **Decides:** $2 / 20 = 10\%$; 18 days are waiting.

A	Camouflage	The tool is not where the waiting happens.
B	Inverted operation	Divides waiting time by lead time instead of work time.
C	Confusion set	Work time is only 2 days; speeding it up barely changes lead time.
D	Correct	Waiting is 90% of lead time, so that is where the waste is.

10. Answer D Concept 7

~~A team has the highest velocity in the department.~~ In retrospectives, a junior developer never raises concerns. Two months ago, the tech lead criticized a teammate in front of everyone for reporting a mistake. What should the Scrum Master do?

Target word: restore psychological safety **Decides:** Mistakes were met with public blame.

A	Dropped element	Collects data but drops the leader behavior causing the problem.
B	Camouflage	Output does not show whether people feel safe.
C	Inverted operation	Forcing speech without safety adds pressure.
D	Correct	Safety comes from how leaders respond when people speak up.

11. Answer D Concept 8

Three months into a project, a customer's market shifts and it asks for a different feature to come first. ~~The original plan is 60 pages and was signed by the steering committee.~~ What is the most agile response?

Target word: response to change **Decides:** Responding to change is valued over following a plan.

A	Camouflage	Formal sign-off does not outweigh a real change in value.
B	Inverted operation	Puts following the plan above responding to change.
C	Absolute language	Plans still have value; they are adapted, not dropped.
D	Correct	Agile adapts the plan to deliver the most value now.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

Which statement correctly reflects the Agile Manifesto?

Target word: read the values correctly **Decides:** Left side valued more; right side still has value.

A	Correct	That is the manifesto's own framing.
B	Confusion set	Swaps a different value pair and reverses it.
C	Inverted operation	Reverses the pair.
D	Absolute language	The manifesto says the right-side items still have value.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	4	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Scrum accountabilities	The Product Owner orders the product backlog; the Scrum Master coaches and removes impediments; Developers decide how to build the work.	Letting the most senior stakeholder or the Scrum Master set priorities.	“Who decides what gets built next?”
2	Purpose of each Scrum event	Sprint Review inspects the product increment with stakeholders; the Retrospective inspects how the team works; the Daily Scrum plans the next 24 hours.	Mixing up Review (the product) and Retrospective (the process).	Whether the topic is the product or the team’s way of working.
3	Velocity-based forecasting	Sprints needed = remaining points / average velocity (rounded up).	Using the best sprint or multiplying instead of dividing.	Remaining story points plus a few past sprint totals.
4	WIP limits and Little’s Law	Average cycle time = work in progress / throughput; lowering WIP shortens cycle time.	Thinking more work in progress means faster delivery.	Items on the board and items finished per day.
5	Definition of Done vs. acceptance criteria	An item is done only when it meets both its own acceptance criteria and the team’s Definition of Done.	Calling a story done because the customer-facing behavior works.	Criteria met but a quality step (review, tests) is missing.
6	Lean waste and flow efficiency	Flow efficiency = active work time / total lead time; the biggest gains usually come from cutting waiting, not working faster.	Trying to speed up the people doing the work.	Long lead time with little hands-on time.
7	Psychological safety	People speak up when mistakes are treated as learning, not blame; leaders create this by how they respond.	Forcing people to talk, or ignoring the issue because output looks good.	A quiet team member and a past public criticism.
8	Agile values	Agile values responding to change over following a plan (and similar pairs) — the right side still has value, the left side is valued more.	Reading the values as “no plans” or “no documentation.”	A mid-project change vs. an approved plan.

Course scope (public description): Agile Methodology introduces students to agile's principles, practices, and mindset, focusing on adaptability, collaboration, and value delivery in dynamic team environments. This course explores how agile methodologies such as scrum, Kanban, and Lean empower teams to respond to change, prioritize meaningful work, and achieve shared goals through iterative progress. Students will develop skills in facilitating agile ceremonies, managing backlogs, and fostering transparency and alignment while building cohesive, self-organizing teams that value inclusivity and psychological safety. Through real-world scenarios and hands-on exercises, students will embrace agile values and principles to enhance collaboration, continuous improvement, and success across diverse contexts. There are no prerequisites for this course.